

Chilled Vidalia Onion and Watercress Soup

2½ pounds Vidalia or other sweet onions,
chopped coarse
3 tablespoons vegetable oil
a ½ pound potato, peeled and diced
4 cups low-salt chicken broth
4 cups loosely packed watercress sprigs,
coarse stems discarded
½ teaspoon dried sage, crumbled
1½ cups half-and-half

In a heavy kettle cook onions in oil, covered, over moderate heat, stirring occasionally, 30 minutes. Reduce heat to moderately low and cook onions, uncovered, stirring, until just pale golden, about 45 minutes. Add potato, broth, watercress, and sage and simmer, covered partially, 15 minutes. In a blender purée soup in batches and transfer as puréed to a bowl. Stir in half-and-half and salt and pepper to taste.

Chill soup, covered, at least 4 hours or overnight. Makes about 8 cups.